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Laser light source

Abstract

A laser light source includes: a laser diode chip including an emission layer, a substrate supporting the emission layer, and an emission end surface; a submount that includes a principal surface on which the laser diode chip is fixed and a pair of lens supports located at opposite sides with respect to the emission end surface of the laser diode chip; a lens bonded to the end surfaces of the pair of lens supports; and a semiconductor laser package housing the aforementioned elements. The laser diode chip is fixed to the submount with the emission layer being closer to the submount than is the substrate. The emission end surface of the laser diode chip is located outward with respect to an edge of the principal surface. The end surfaces of the pair of lens supports are located outward with respect to the first end surface of the laser diode chip.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to a laser light source.

BACKGROUND ART

(2) Laser light sources can be used for various applications, such as processing, projectors, and illumination devices. A typical example of such a laser light source may include a laser diode chip, a submount supporting the laser diode chip, and a collimating lens to reduce the divergence angle of laser light that is emitted from the laser diode chip (for example, Patent Document 1). In the case in which a laser diode chip, a submount, and a lens such as a collimating lens are housed in a semiconductor laser package, the laser light can be collimated or the like by a small lens before great divergence of the laser light occurs. On the other hand, even a slight misalignment between the laser diode chip and the lens may cause a great deviation in orientation of the optical axis of laser light that is emitted to the outside from the laser light source.

CITATION LIST

Patent Literature

(3) [Patent Document 1] Japanese Patent Publication No. 2000-98190

SUMMARY OF INVENTION

Technical Problem

(4) A laser light source is desired in which misalignment between a laser diode chip and a lens is unlikely to occur.

Solution to Problem

(5) According to one embodiment of the present disclosure, a laser light source includes an edge-emitting type laser diode chip that includes: a semiconductor multilayer structure including an emission layer; a substrate supporting the semiconductor multilayer structure; a first end surface through which laser light generated in the emission layer is emitted; and a second end surface opposite to the first end surface, wherein a distance from the first end surface to the second end surface defines a cavity length; a submount having a principal surface on which the laser diode chip is fixed, wherein the submount includes a pair of lens supports located at opposite sides with respect to the first end surface of the laser diode chip and a back surface located opposite to the principal surface; a lens bonded to end surfaces of the pair of lens supports; and a semiconductor laser package housing the laser diode chip, the lens, and the submount, wherein, the laser diode chip is fixed to the submount with the emission layer being closer to the submount than is the substrate of the laser diode chip; the first end surface of the laser diode chip is located outward in a direction along the cavity length with respect to an edge of the principal surface; and the end surfaces of the pair of lens supports are located outward with respect to the first end surface of the laser diode chip in the direction along the cavity length.

Advantageous Effects of Invention

(6) According to certain embodiments of the present disclosure, a laser light source can be realized in which a misalignment between a laser diode chip and a lens is unlikely to occur.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of a laser light source **100** according to Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure.
- (2) FIG. 1B is a diagram schematically showing a planar configuration of the laser light source **100** in FIG. 1A.
- (3) FIG. 2A is a perspective view showing in more detail the configuration of the laser light source **100** in FIG. 1A, in which a semiconductor laser package **40** and a pair of lead terminals **50** are not shown.
- (4) FIG. 2B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **100** in FIG. 2A.
- (5) FIG. 2C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 2B taken along line IIC-IIC, which is parallel to the YZ plane.
- (6) FIG. 3A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of a laser light source **110** according to Modified Example 1 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure.
- (7) FIG. 3B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **110** in FIG. 3A.
- (8) FIG. 3C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 3B taken along line IIIC-IIIC, which is parallel to the YZ plane.
- (9) FIG. 4A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of a laser light source **120** according to Modified Example 2 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure.
- (10) FIG. 4B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **120** in FIG. 4A.
- (11) FIG. 4C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 4B taken along line IVC-IVC, which is parallel to the YZ plane.
- (12) FIG. 5A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of a laser light source **130** according to Modified Example 3 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure.
- (13) FIG. 5B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **130** in FIG. 5A.
- (14) FIG. 5C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 5B taken along line VC-VC, which is parallel to the YZ plane.
- (15) FIG. 6A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of a laser light source **140** according to Modified Example 4 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure.

- (16) FIG. 6B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **140** in FIG. 6A.
- (17) FIG. 6C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 6B taken along line VIC-VIC, which is parallel to the YZ plane.
- (18) FIG. 7A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of a laser light source **150** according to Modified Example 5 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure.
- (19) FIG. 7B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **150** in FIG. 7A.
- (20) FIG. 7C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 7B taken along line VIIC-VIIC, which is parallel to the YZ plane.
- (21) FIG. 7D is a perspective view schematically showing a collimating lens **30** of the laser light source **150** in FIG. 7A being bonded to a submount **20** using a collet **60**.
- (22) FIG. 8A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of a laser light source **200** according to Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure.
- (23) FIG. 8B is a top plan view schematically the laser light source **200** in FIG. 8A.
- (24) FIG. 8C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 8B taken along line VIIC-VIIC, which is parallel to the YZ plane.
- (25) FIG. 8D is a rear view schematically showing the laser light source **200** in FIG. 8A.
- (26) FIG. 9A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of a laser light source **210** according to Modified Example 1 of Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure.
- (27) FIG. 9B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **210** in FIG. 9A.
- (28) FIG. 9C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 9B taken along line IXC-IXC, which is parallel to the YZ plane.
- (29) FIG. 9D is a rear view schematically showing the laser light source **210** in FIG. 9A.
- (30) FIG. 10A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of a laser light source **220** according to Modified Example 2 of Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure.
- (31) FIG. 10B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **220** in FIG. 10A.
- (32) FIG. 10C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 10B taken along line XC-XC, which is parallel to the YZ plane.
- (33) FIG. 10D is a perspective view schematically showing a fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** and a collimating lens **30** in FIG. 10A.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

- (34) Hereinafter, with reference to the drawings, laser light sources according to embodiments of the present disclosure will be described in detail. The same reference characters in a plurality of drawings denote the same or similar parts.
- (35) Moreover, while the description below is intended to give a concrete form to the technical ideas of the present disclosure; the present disclosure is not limited to the described embodiments. The dimensions, material, shape, relative arrangement, etc., of the components are intended as examples, and the scope of the present disclosure is not intended to be limited thereto. The size, arrangement relationship, etc., of the members shown in each drawing may be exaggerated in order to facilitate understanding.

Embodiment 1

- (36) First, with reference to FIG. 1A and FIG. 1B, and FIG. 2A to FIG. 2C, an example of a fundamental configuration of a laser light source according to Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure will be described.
- (37) FIG. 1A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of a laser light source **100** according to Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure. FIG. 1B is a diagram schematically showing a planar configuration of the laser light source **100** in FIG. 1A. The laser light source **100** of the present embodiment includes a laser diode chip **10**, a submount **20** supporting the laser diode chip **10**, a collimating lens **30** supported by the submount **20**, and a semiconductor laser package **40** housing these elements or components. Moreover, the laser light source **100** of the present embodiment includes a pair of lead terminals **50** that penetrate the

semiconductor laser package **40** and that supply power to the laser diode chip **10**. The semiconductor laser package **40** includes a lid **40L**, a base **40b**, and a light-transmitting window **40w**. In the laser light source **100** of the present embodiment, laser light that has been emitted from the laser diode chip **10** and collimated by the collimating lens **30** is extracted to the outside through the light-transmitting window **40w**.

(38) Although the lid **40L**, the base **40b**, and the light-transmitting window **40w** of the semiconductor laser package **40** are shown isolated in FIG. **1A** for ease of understanding, they are actually bonded to one another. In FIG. **1B**, the lid **40L** of the semiconductor laser package **40** is omitted from illustration.

(39) In the figures, an X axis, a Y axis, and a Z axis that are orthogonal to one another are schematically shown for reference. For ease of understanding, in the present disclosure, a side at which the laser diode chip **10**, the submount **20**, and the collimating lens **30** are located in the base **40b** may be indicated as an “upper” side. This does not restrict the orientation of the laser light source **100** in use; rather, the laser light source **100** may be oriented in any appropriate direction.

(40) FIG. **2A** is a perspective view showing in more detail the configuration of the laser light source **100** in FIG. **1A**, in which the semiconductor laser package **40** and the pair of lead terminals **50** are omitted. The region surrounded by a broken line in FIG. **2A** shows an example of a detailed structure of the laser diode chip **10** being disposed in the submount **20**. Although the submount **20** and the collimating lens **30** are shown isolated in FIG. **2A**, they are actually bonded to each other. FIG. **2B** is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **100** in FIG. **2A**. FIG. **2C** is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. **2B** taken along line IIC-IIC, which is parallel to the YZ plane. In the present disclosure, a side at which the collimating lens **30** is located with respect to the submount **20** may be referred to as the “front.”

(41) As shown in FIG. **2A**, the laser diode chip **10** is an edge-emitting type laser diode chip including: a semiconductor multilayer structure **10a** that includes a first cladding layer **10C.sub.1**, a second cladding layer **10C.sub.2**, and an emission layer **10L**; a substrate **10b** supporting the semiconductor multilayer structure **10a**; an emission end surface **10e.sub.1** through which the high-power laser light that has been generated in the emission layer **10L** is emitted; and a rear end surface **10e.sub.2** opposite to the emission end surface **10e.sub.1**. The emission layer **10L** is located between the first cladding layer **10C.sub.1** and the second cladding layer **10C.sub.2**. The laser diode chip **10** may include other layers, such as a buffer layer and a contact layer. In the present disclosure, the “emission end surface **10e.sub.1**” may be referred to as the “first end surface **10e.sub.1**,” while the “rear end surface **10e.sub.2**” may be referred to as the “second end surface **10e.sub.2**.”

(42) The laser diode chip **10** is fixed to the submount **20** in a face-down state, i.e., so that the emission layer **10L** is closer to the submount **20** than is the substrate **10b**. The total size of the semiconductor multilayer structure **10a** and the substrate **10b** of the laser diode chip **10** along the Y direction is about 80 μm . The total size of the substrate **10b** and the first cladding layer **10C.sub.1** along the Y direction is greater than the size of the second cladding layer **10C.sub.2** along the Y direction. In a face-down state, the distance between the emission layer **10L** and the submount **20** is about 1/10 of that in a face-up state (in which the emission layer **10L** would be farther from the submount **20** than is the substrate **10b**). Therefore, in a face-down state, even if high-power laser light is emitted from the emission layer **10L**, heat generated in the emission layer **10L** can be efficiently transmitted to the submount **20**. The output power of laser light according to the present embodiment is e.g. 3 W or greater and 50 W or less.

(43) The semiconductor multilayer structure **10a** may have a double-hetero structure to generate an energy level of a quantum well, for example. The emission layer **10L** has a band gap that is smaller than the band gaps of the first cladding layer **10C.sub.1** and the second cladding layer **10C.sub.2**. In the present embodiment, the substrate **10b** and the first cladding layer **10C.sub.1** on the substrate **10b** may each be composed of an n type semiconductor. The emission layer **10L** may be composed

of an intrinsic semiconductor, an n type semiconductor, or a p type semiconductor, and the second cladding layer **10C.sub.2** on the emission layer **10L** may be composed of a p type semiconductor. The n type and the p type may be reversed. When an electric current is injected from the p type cladding layer to the n type cladding layer, a population inversion of carriers occurs in the emission layer **10L**, resulting in a stimulated emission of light from the emission layer **10L**. The refractive index of the emission layer **10L** is designed to be higher than those of the first cladding layer **10C.sub.1** and the second cladding layer **10C.sub.2**, so that light generated in the emission layer **10L** is confined within the emission layer **10L** via total reflection. The emission layer **10L** functions as a cavity, so that laser light is emitted from the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the emission layer **10L**. The cavity length of the emission layer **10L** is defined by the distance from the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** to the rear end surface **10e.sub.2**. The direction of the cavity length is parallel to the Z direction. The cavity length is e.g. not less than 500 μm and not more than 5000 μm . A longer cavity length allows for a broader contact area between the laser diode chip **10** and the submount **20**, so that the heat generated in the emission layer **10L** can be efficiently transmitted to the submount **20**.

(44) When the laser light emitted from the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** propagates, it quickly diverges in the YZ plane and slow in the XZ plane. When not being collimated, the laser light spot has an elliptical shape in the far field, such that the elliptical shape has a major axis along the Y direction and a minor axis along the X direction, in the XY plane.

(45) The laser diode chip **10** is able to emit laser light of violet, blue, green, or red in the visible region, or infrared or ultraviolet laser light. The emission peak wavelength of violet is preferably 350 nm or greater and 419 nm or less, and more preferably 400 nm or greater and 415 nm or less. The emission peak wavelength of blue light is preferably 420 nm or greater and 494 nm or less, and more preferably 440 nm or greater and 475 nm or less. Examples of a semiconductor laser device to emit violet or blue laser light include a semiconductor laser device containing a nitride semiconductor. Examples of nitride semiconductors include GaN, InGaN, and AlGaIn. The emission peak wavelength of green light is preferably 495 nm or greater and 570 nm or less, and more preferably 510 nm or greater and 550 nm or less. Examples of a semiconductor laser device to emit green laser light include a semiconductor laser device containing a nitride semiconductor. Examples of nitride semiconductors include GaN, InGaIn, and AlGaIn. The emission peak wavelength of red light is preferably 605 nm or greater and 750 nm or less, and more preferably 610 nm or greater and 700 nm or less. Examples of a semiconductor laser device to emit red laser light include a semiconductor laser device containing an InAlGaP-based, GaInP-based, GaAs-based, or AlGaAs-based semiconductor. As a semiconductor laser device for red light, a semiconductor laser device having two or more waveguide regions may be used. Semiconductor laser devices containing such semiconductors are more prone to a decrease in the output power associated with heat than semiconductor laser devices containing nitride semiconductors. Increase of waveguide regions allows for dispersing heat, so that decrease in the output power of the semiconductor laser device can be reduced.

(46) The submount **20** includes: a principal surface **20s.sub.1** on which the laser diode chip **10** is fixed; a pair of lens supports **20LS** located at opposite sides with respect to the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10**; a back surface **20s2** located opposite to the principal surface **20s.sub.1**; and a front end surface **20fe** connecting the principal surface **20s.sub.1** and the back surface **20s.sub.2**. The principal surface **20s.sub.1** and the front end surface **20fe** define an edge **20ed** of the principal surface **20s.sub.1**. In the example shown in FIG. 2A, the pair of lens supports **20LS** are a pair of protrusions being located at opposite sides with respect to the laser diode chip **10** and extending along the Z direction. In any portion behind the front end surface **20fe**, the submount **20** has a U-shape continuously along the Z direction; this U-shape is created by dividing, along a plane parallel to the XZ plane, a prismatic body that is mirror-symmetric with respect to a plane parallel to the YZ plane and that extends along the Z direction. End surfaces **20se**

of the pair of lens supports **20LS** is located outward in a direction along the cavity length with respect to the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10**. The normal direction of the principal surface **20s.sub.1** is parallel to the Y direction.

(47) The distance between the end surface **20se** of each of the pair of lens supports **20LS** and the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** along the Z direction may be designed to be substantially equal to the focal length of the collimating lens **30**. The distance between the end surface **20se** of each of the pair of lens supports **20LS** and the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** along the Z direction is e.g. 50 μm or greater and 100 μm or less. The size of each of the pair of lens supports **20LS** along the Y direction may be approximately the same as the size of the collimating lens **30** along the Y direction; the size of each of the pair of lens supports **20LS** along the Y direction may be greater than, equal to, or smaller than the size of the collimating lens **30** along the Y direction. The size of each of the pair of lens supports **20LS** along the Y direction is e.g. 100 μm or greater and 500 μm or less.

(48) The size of the submount **20** along the X direction is e.g. 1 mm or greater and 3 mm or less, and the size of a portion of the submount **20** other than the pair of lens supports **20LS** along the Y direction is e.g. 100 μm or greater and 500 μm or less, and the size of a portion of the submount **20** other than the pair of lens supports **20LS** along the Z direction is e.g. 1 mm or greater and 6 mm or less. In the present disclosure, the upper limits of these sizes may be determined in view of reduction in size of the laser light source **100**.

(49) In the submount **20**, the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** is located outward with respect to the edge **20ed** of the principal surface **20s.sub.1** in a direction along the cavity length. The distance between the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** and the edge **20ed** of the principal surface **20s.sub.1** along the Z direction is e.g. 2 μm or greater and 50 μm or less. With this arrangement, even if the laser diode chip **10** and the principal surface **20s.sub.1** of the submount **20** are fixed by a bonding material of an inorganic material such as gold tin (AuSn) in a face-down state, for example, climb-up of the bonding material onto the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the emission layer **10L** can be reduced. In the laser light source disclosed in Patent Document 1, when the laser diode chip is disposed in a face-down state, the bonding material that bonds the laser diode chip and the submount together may possibly climb onto the emission end surface of the emission layer of the laser diode chip, which may result in a decrease in the output power of the laser light that is emitted from the laser diode chip. In the laser light source **100** of the present embodiment, such a decrease in the output power of laser light can be reduced.

(50) A portion or a whole of the submount **20** may be made of a ceramic containing at least one selected from the group consisting of AlN, SiC, and aluminum oxide or an alloy such as CuW, for example. The submount **20** can be provided by sintering a powder of ceramic, for example. The thermal conductivity of the ceramic may be e.g. 10 [W/m.Math.K] or greater and 500 [W/m.Math.K] or less. In order to reduce deformation due to the heat that is applied when fixing the laser diode chip **10**, the ceramic may have a low coefficient of thermal expansion. The coefficient of thermal expansion may be 2×10^{-6} [1/K] or greater and 1×10^{-5} [1/K] or less. On the principal surface **20s.sub.1** and the back surface **20s.sub.2** of the submount **20**, a metal film (such as gold plating) having a thickness of e.g. 0.5 μm or greater and 10 μm or less may be formed. With the metal film disposed on the principal surface **20s.sub.1**, the laser diode chip **10** can be bonded to the principal surface **20s.sub.1** via, for example, gold tin. With the metal film disposed on the back surface **20s.sub.2**, the submount **20** can be bonded to a bottom **40b.sub.1** via, for example, gold tin.

(51) The collimating lens **30** is a so-called FAC (Fast Axis Collimator) lens which collimates, within the laser light emitted from the laser diode chip **10**, components of the laser light that diverge significantly in the YZ plane. Optionally, a so-called SAC (Slow Axis Collimator) lens (not shown) that collimates, within the laser light, components that diverge to a lesser extent in the XZ

plane may be disposed outside the laser light source **100**. In the present disclosure, to “collimate” means not only converting laser light into parallel light, but also reducing the divergence angle of the laser light. Depending on the application, other lenses such as a converging lens may be used instead of the collimating lens **30**.

(52) The collimating lens **30** is a cylindrical lens having a structure that is elongated along the X direction, and has no or little curvature along the X direction and a curvature along the Y direction. The direction in which the collimating lens **30** extends is a direction that is perpendicular to both the normal direction of the principal surface **20s.sub.1** of the submount **20** and the cavity length direction. With the approximately same size of the collimating lens **30** and the pair of lens supports **20LS** along the Y direction, it is easy to dispose the collimating lens **30** such that the centroid of the collimating lens **30** is located between the pair of lens supports **20LS** when viewed in the cavity length direction. Based on this relative positioning of the centroid of the collimating lens **30**, the collimating lens **30** can be stably disposed on the submount **20** with a good accuracy.

(53) In the present embodiment, with respect to the back surface **20s.sub.2** of the submount **20**, the upper surface of each of the pair of lens supports **20LS** is located at a height along the Y direction substantially equal to the height along the Y direction at which the upper surface of the collimating lens **30** is located. The position of the collimating lens **30** relative to the pair of lens supports **20LS** is coarsely adjusted so that the above two heights are substantially equal. Thereafter, while laser light is allowed to be emitted from the laser diode chip **10**, the position of the collimating lens **30** relative to the pair of lens supports **20LS** is finely adjusted so that the laser light is appropriately collimated. The aforementioned two heights are not necessarily substantially equal, but may be different from each other.

(54) In the present embodiment, the collimating lens **30** is uniform along the X direction, and therefore the alignment between the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** and the collimating lens **30** along the X direction does not need to be taken into consideration. It is sufficient that, in the collimating lens **30**, at least a facing portion, i.e., a portion facing the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10**, and a peripheral portion near the facing portion are uniform along the X direction. Therefore, the remainders, i.e., side portions, do not need to be uniform along the X direction, and do not need to be transparent. The size of each of side portions of the collimating lens **30** along the Y direction may be greater than, equal to, or smaller than the sizes of the facing portion and the peripheral portion along the Y direction. The collimating lens **30** may be made of at least one of glass, quartz, synthetic quartz, sapphire, transparent ceramics, and plastics, for example.

(55) The collimating lens **30** is bonded to the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS** in a direction along the Z direction. Even if there is a slight variation in the thickness of a bonding material that bonds together the collimating lens **30** and the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS**, such variation hardly affects the position of the collimating lens **30** along the Y direction. There may be a configuration in which a pedestal having a surface parallel to the principal surface **20s.sub.1** is disposed in front of the submount **20** and the collimating lens **30** is disposed on the surface of the pedestal, which is different from a configuration in the present embodiment. However, in such a configuration, if variation occurs in the thickness of the bonding material between the collimating lens **30** and the surface of the pedestal, a misalignment along the Y direction may occur between the laser diode chip **10** and the collimating lens **30**, so that the optical axis of the laser light that is emitted from the laser light source **100** to the outside may possibly be greatly misoriented. On the other hand, in the present embodiment, misalignments between the laser diode chip **10** and the collimating lens **30** along the Y direction are less likely to occur, and the optical axis of the laser light that is emitted from the laser light source **100** to the outside can be oriented in a direction as designed. In the present embodiment, even if a slight variation occurs in the thickness of the bonding material, such variation results in merely a slight deviation in the position of the collimating lens **30** along the optical axis of the laser light, which

hardly affects the orientation of the optical axis of the laser light.

(56) The collimating lens **30** and the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS** may be bonded by a bonding material of an inorganic material such as gold tin. Metal films may be previously formed on the bonding surface of the collimating lens **30** and the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS**. Such metal films allow, for example, bonding with gold tin. The bonding temperature for gold tin is about 280° C. Given that the ceramic composing the submount **20** has a low thermal conductivity, the influences of heat, applied during bonding of the collimating lens **30** and the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS**, on the laser diode chip **10** can be reduced.

(57) In another example, the collimating lens **30** and the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS** may be bonded together with a bonding material containing a thermosetting resin. The bonding temperature for thermosetting resins is about 100° C., which is lower than the bonding temperature for inorganic materials. Therefore, the influences of heat, applied during bonding of the end surfaces **20se** of the collimating lens **30** and the pair of lens supports **20LS**, on the laser diode chip **10** can be further reduced. During bonding between the collimating lens **30** and the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS**, the thermosetting resin may be heated by irradiating the position indicated by a point P shown in FIG. 2A with laser light, for example. The distance between the position of point P and each of the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS** along the Z direction is e.g. 50 μm or greater and 500 μm or less. In the present embodiment, in a top plan view, the optical axis of the laser light emitted from the laser diode chip **10** and the bonding material do not overlap each other; therefore, even if an out-gas is generated from the bonding material containing a thermosetting resin, the out-gas can be hindered from approaching toward the laser diode chip **10**. This can reduce occurrence of dust attraction (described later) at the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10**.

(58) Some inorganic material-based bonding materials may contain organic matter as a binder. Using such bonding materials to effect the bonding between the collimating lens **30** and the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS** can also restrain the out-gas, generated by heating, from approaching the laser diode chip **10**.

(59) Without even using a bonding material, the collimating lens **30** and the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS** may be bonded via direct bonding. Examples of direct bonding include diffusion bonding, room temperature bonding, and anodic bonding.

(60) As will be clear from the description of the embodiment using a bonding material, bonding via direct bonding can reduce misalignments of the collimating lens **30** along the Y direction as in bonding via a bonding material does.

(61) In the laser light source **100** of the present embodiment, the submount **20** supports the laser diode chip **10** and the collimating lens **30**. With the reduced distance between the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** and the collimating lens **30**, divergence of laser light emitted from the laser diode chip **10** can be reduced by the small collimating lens **30** instead of occurrence of great divergence. This allows for obtaining the laser light source **100** of a small size. Also, the diameter of a collimated beam passing through the collimating lens **30** can be reduced.

(62) The semiconductor laser package **40** may hermetically seal the laser diode chip **10**, the submount **20**, and the collimating lens **30**. When the laser diode chip **10** emits laser light of a short wavelength, e.g., 350 nm or greater and 570 nm or less, organic gas components and the like that are contained in the ambient may be decomposed by the laser light, so that the decomposed matter may adhere to the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10**. Moreover, if the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** is in contact with the outside air, deterioration of the end surface may progress during operation due to dust attraction or the like. Such deterioration of the end surface may lead to decrease in the optical output power of the laser diode chip **10**. In order to enhance the reliability of the laser diode chip **10** for extending the operation life, it is preferable that the semiconductor laser package **40** seals the laser diode chip **10**

hermetically. Hermetic sealing by the semiconductor laser package **40** may be conducted regardless of the wavelength of the laser light to be emitted from the laser diode chip **10**.

(63) The base **40b** of the semiconductor laser package **40** is in thermal contact with the back surface **20s.sub.2** of the submount **20**. The base **40b** may be made of a material of high thermal conductivity. The material is a metal, including, for example, at least one selected from the group consisting of Cu, Al, Ag, Fe, Ni, Mo, Cu, W, and CuMo. In order to align the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** and the light-transmitting window **40w** in height, a member **40m** of high thermal conductivity may be disposed between a bottom surface **40bt** of the base **40b** and the submount **20**, as shown in FIG. **1B**. The member **40m** may be made of the same material as that of the portion of the base **40b** including the bottom surface **40bt**. Alternatively, at least a portion of the bottom surface **40bt** of the base **40b** may project upward, and the submount **20** may be disposed on this projecting portion of the bottom surface **40bt**. The portion of the base **40b** including the bottom surface **40bt** may be made of copper, for example. The portion of the base **40b** that surrounds the laser diode **10**, the submount **20**, and the collimating lens **30** may be made of kovar, for example. Kovar is an alloy in which nickel and cobalt are added to iron, which is a main component. The lid **40L** of the semiconductor laser package **40** may be made of the same material as, or a different material from, that of the base **40b**. The light-transmitting window **40w** of the semiconductor laser package **40**, which is mounted on the base **40b**, transmits the laser light emitted from the laser diode chip **10**. Similarly to the collimating lens **30**, the light-transmitting window **40w** of the semiconductor laser package **40** can be made of at least one of glass, quartz, synthetic quartz, sapphire, transparent ceramics, and plastics, for example.

(64) Each of the pair of lead terminals **50** is electrically connected to the laser diode chip **10** via a wire as described below. In the example shown in FIG. **2A**, a metal film (e.g., gold plating) is disposed on the upper surface of the laser diode chip **10**. This metal film is electrically connected to one of the pair of lead terminals **50** via a wire. Similarly, a metal film (e.g., gold plating) is also disposed on the principal surface **20s.sub.1** of the submount **20**. This metal film is electrically connected to the other one of the pair of lead terminals **50** via a wire. Via the pair of lead terminals **50**, an electric current is injected from the second cladding layer **10C.sub.2** to the first cladding layer **10C.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10**. The pair of lead terminals **50** are electrically connected to an external circuit (not shown) that adjusts the emission timing and the output power of laser light to be emitted from the laser diode chip **10**. The pair of lead terminals **50** are made of a material having good electrical conduction. Examples of such materials include Fe—Ni alloys, Cu alloys, and other metals.

(65) In the laser light source **100** of the present embodiment, the submount **20** supports the laser diode chip **10** on the principal surface **20s.sub.1** between the pair of lens supports **20LS**, and supports the collimating lens **30** with the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS**. This allows for facilitating alignment between the laser diode chip **10** and the collimating lens **30** as described above, and the laser light source **100** of a small size can be obtained. Furthermore, in the laser light source **100** of the present embodiment, even when the laser diode chip **10** is disposed on the submount **20** in a face-down state, climbing-up of the bonding material onto the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** can be reduced.

Modified Examples of Embodiment 1

(66) Next, Modified Examples 1 to 5 of the laser light source **100** according to Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure will be described. In the Modified Examples described below, the semiconductor laser package **40** and the pair of lead terminals **50** will be omitted from illustration. Descriptions repetitive of the description above may be omitted.

(67) With reference to FIG. **3A** to FIG. **3C**, an example of a configuration of a laser light source **110** according to Modified Example 1 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure will be described. FIG. **3A** is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of the laser light source **110** according to Modified Example 1 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure. FIG.

3B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **110** in FIG. 3A. FIG. 3C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 3B taken along line IIIC-IIIC, which is parallel to the YZ plane. The laser light source **110** according to Modified Example 1 of Embodiment 1 differs from the laser light source **100** according to Embodiment 1 in the shape of the submount **20**. The front end surface **20fe** of the submount **20** includes a central end surface **20fe.sub.1**, and side end surfaces **20fe.sub.2** located on opposite sides of the central end surface **20fe.sub.1**. The central end surface **20fe.sub.1** is recessed with respect to the side end surfaces **20fe.sub.2** in a direction along the cavity length.

(68) The edge **20ed** of the principal surface **20s.sub.1** according to Modified Example 1 of Embodiment 1 is defined by the principal surface **20s.sub.1** and the central end surface **20fe.sub.1**. The recess in the central end surface **20fe.sub.1** has a size along the Z direction of e.g. 5 μm or greater and 100 μm or less, a size along the X direction of e.g. 50 μm or greater and 200 μm or less, and the size along the Y direction below the principal surface **20s.sub.1** of e.g. 100 μm or greater and 500 μm or less. The recess does not need to penetrate throughout the Y direction.

(69) The emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** is located outward in a direction along the cavity length with respect to the edge **20ed** of the principal surface **20s.sub.1**, which is defined by the principal surface **20s.sub.1** and the central end surface **20fe.sub.1**. Similarly to the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS**, the side end surfaces **20fe.sub.2** of the submount **20** is located outward with respect to the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** in a direction along the cavity length. With the edge **20ed** of the principal surface **20s.sub.1** being defined by the principal surface **20s.sub.1** and the central end surface **20fe.sub.1**, climbing-up of the bonding material onto the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** can be reduced. The submount **20** according to Modified Example 1 of Embodiment 1 can be obtained by removing a portion in the front end surface **20fe** from the aforementioned U shape continuously along the Z direction, and thus can be easily produced. Moreover, the collimating lens **30** is bonded to an L-shaped end surface containing the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS** and the side end surfaces **20fe.sub.2**. This allows for increasing the contact area between the collimating lens **30** and the submount **20**, which can facilitate bonding.

(70) Next, with reference to FIG. 4A to FIG. 4C, an example of a configuration of a laser light source **120** according to Modified Example 2 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure will be described. FIG. 4A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of the laser light source **120** according to Modified Example 2 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure. FIG. 4B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **120** in FIG. 4A. FIG. 4C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 4B taken along line IVC-IVC, which is parallel to the YZ plane. The laser light source **120** according to Modified Example 2 of Embodiment 1 differs from the laser light source **100** according to Embodiment 1 in the shape of the submount **20**. The submount **20** according to Modified Example 2 of Embodiment 1 has a groove **20d** between each of the pair of lens supports **20LS** and the laser diode chip **10**, the grooves **20d** extending in a direction along the cavity length. Although the example shown in FIG. 4B illustrates that the grooves **20d** adjoin the pair of lens supports **20LS**, the grooves **20d** do not need to adjoin the pair of lens supports **20LS**. Each groove **20d** has a size along the X direction of e.g. 100 μm or greater and 500 μm or less, a size along the Y direction of e.g. 50 μm or greater and 300 μm or less, and a size along the Z direction below the edge **20ed** of the principal surface **20s.sub.1** of e.g. 1 mm or greater and 6 mm or less. The grooves **20d** do not need to penetrate throughout the Z direction. With the grooves **20d**, influence of heat, applied during bonding of the collimating lens **30** and the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS**, on the laser diode chip **10** can be reduced.

(71) Next, with reference to FIG. 5A to FIG. 5C, an example of a configuration of a laser light source **130** according to Modified Example 3 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure will be described. FIG. 5A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of

the laser light source **130** according to Modified Example 3 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure. FIG. 5B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **130** in FIG. 5A. FIG. 5C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 5B taken along line VC-VC, which is parallel to the YZ plane. The laser light source **130** according to Modified Example 3 of Embodiment 1 differs from the laser light source **100** according to Embodiment 1 in the configuration of the submount **20**. The submount **20** according to Modified Example 3 of Embodiment 1 includes a first submount portion **20p.sub.1** and a second submount portion **20p2**. The first submount portion **20p.sub.1** includes a pair of lens supports **20LS** on an upper surface **20us**. The first submount portion **20p.sub.1** has the aforementioned U shape continuously along the Z direction. The first submount portion **20p.sub.1** may be made of a ceramic containing at least one selected from the group consisting of AlN, SiC, and aluminum oxide or an alloy such as CuW, for example. The second submount portion **20p.sub.2** is fixed on the upper surface **20us** of the first submount portion **20p.sub.1**, so as to be located between the pair of lens supports **20LS**. The second submount portion **20p.sub.2** has a principal surface **20s.sub.1** on which the laser diode chip **10** is mounted, and a front end surface **20fe** facing the collimating lens **30**. The principal surface **20s.sub.1** is a surface of the first submount portion **20p.sub.1** that is opposite to a surface being fixed to the upper surface **20us**. In the present disclosure, the front end surface **20fe** and the back surface **20s.sub.2** do not need to be directly joined. In the present disclosure, one side of the front end surface **20fe** abuts with one side of the principal surface **20s.sub.1**, and this side along which the front end surface **20fe** and the principal surface **20s.sub.1** abut each other defines the edge **20ed** of the principal surface **20s.sub.1**. When the thermal conductivity of the second submount portion **20p.sub.2** is higher than the thermal conductivity of the first submount portion **20p.sub.1**, heat that is generated from the laser diode chip **10** can be efficiently transmitted to the outside. The second submount portion **20p.sub.2** may be made of at least one selected from the group consisting of Cu, Al, Ag, Fe, Ni, Mo, Cu, W, CuW, CuMo, AlN, SiC, and aluminum oxide, for example. The second submount portion **20p.sub.2** has a size along the X direction of e.g. 0.5 mm or greater and 1.5 mm or less, a size along the Y direction of e.g. 0.1 mm or greater and 0.5 mm or less, and a size along the Z direction of e.g. 1 mm or greater and 6 mm or less.

(72) In the submount **20**, the first submount portion **20p.sub.1** and the second submount portion **20p.sub.2** are separate pieces, so that the position of the second submount portion **20p.sub.2** can be adjusted on the first submount portion **20p.sub.1**. As in this example, the submount **20** may include a part having the principal surface **20s.sub.1** and a part having the pair of lens supports **20LS**, these parts being separate pieces. In this submount **20**, an interspace **20g** exists between each of the pair of lens supports **20LS** and the second submount portion **20p.sub.2**. The size of each interspace **20g** along the X direction is e.g. 50 μm or greater and 300 μm or less. The sizes of each interspace **20g** along the Y direction and the Z direction are determined by the sizes of the second submount portion **20p.sub.2** along the Y direction and the Z direction, respectively. With the interspaces **20g**, influence of the heat, exerted during bonding of the collimating lens **30** and the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS**, on the laser diode chip **10** can be reduced as in the laser light source **120** according to Modified Example 2 of Embodiment 1.

(73) Next, with reference to FIG. 6A to FIG. 6C, an example of a configuration of a laser light source **140** according to Modified Example 4 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure will be described. FIG. 6A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of the laser light source **140** according to Modified Example 4 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure. Although the laser diode chip **10**, the submount **20**, and the collimating lens **30** are shown isolated in FIG. 6A, they are actually bonded to one another. FIG. 6B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **140** in FIG. 6A. FIG. 6C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 6B taken along line VIC-VIC, which is parallel to the YZ plane. The laser light source **140** according to Modified Example 4 of Embodiment 1 differs from the laser light source **100** according to Embodiment 1 in the configuration of the submount **20**. The submount **20**

according to Modified Example 4 of Embodiment 1 defines a through-hole **20h** extending from the principal surface **20s.sub.1** and reaching the back surface **20s.sub.2** and includes a metal **20m** filling the through-hole **20h**. A portion of the submount **20** other than the through-hole **20h** may be made of, for example, a ceramic. The metal **20m** has a high thermal conductivity, and may contain at least one selected from the group consisting of Cu, Al, Ag, Fe, Ni, Mo, Cu, W, and CuMo, for example. The metal **20m** has a largest size along the X direction of e.g. 0.5 mm or greater and 1.5 mm or less, and a largest size along the Z direction of e.g. 1 mm or greater and 6 mm or less. In a top plan view, a whole or a portion of the metal **20m** may overlap the laser diode chip **10**. With the laser diode chip **10** disposed in contact with the metal **20m** of the submount **20**, the heat generated from the laser diode chip **10** can be efficiently transmitted to the semiconductor laser package **40** via the metal **20m**.

(74) Next, with reference to FIG. 7A to FIG. 7C, an example of a configuration of a laser light source **150** according to Modified Example 5 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure will be described. FIG. 7A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of the laser light source **150** according to Modified Example 5 of Embodiment 1 of the present disclosure. FIG. 7B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **150** in FIG. 7A. FIG. 7C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 7B taken along line VIIC-VIIC, which is parallel to the YZ plane. The laser light source **150** according to Modified Example 5 of Embodiment 1 differs from the laser light source **100** according to Embodiment 1 in the shape of the collimating lens **30**. The collimating lens **30** according to Modified Example 5 of Embodiment 1 includes a pair of flat portions **30f** and a lens curved-surface portion **30c** located between the pair of flat portions **30f**. Similarly to the collimating lens **30** according to Embodiment 1, the lens curved-surface portion **30c** according to Modified Example 5 of Embodiment 1 functions as an FAC lens.

(75) Next, with reference to FIG. 7D, an advantage associated with the pair of flat portions **30f** of the collimating lens **30** will be described. FIG. 7D is a perspective view schematically showing the collimating lens **30** of the laser light source **150** in FIG. 7A being bonded to the submount **20** using a collet **60**. The collet **60** includes fork portions **60a** and a support portion **60b** that is connected to the fork portions **60a**. The collet **60** has a hollow structure, and is able to suck the collimating lens **30** and support it. Specifically, the pair of flat portions **30f** of the collimating lens **30** are sucked onto tip portions of the fork portions **60a** of the collet **60**. The support portion **60b** is held by a mounting apparatus, and while the collimating lens **30** is supported by the fork portions **60a**, the collimating lens **30** may be bonded to the submount **20**, which allows for stably applying a load in a direction perpendicular to the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS**. With the load applied, the bonding material existing between the collimating lens **30** and the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS** is heated.

(76) A mirror (not shown) may be provided between the fork portions **60a** of the collet **60**. While laser light is allowed to be emitted from the laser diode chip **10** in the Z direction, the collimating lens **30** is bonded to the submount **20**, and laser light that is reflected at the mirror (not shown) along the Y direction may be received by a photodetection device, so that alignment between the collimating lens **30** and the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** can be accurately performed. The photodetection device may be a power meter, a parallelism meter, or a beam profiler, for example.

Embodiment 2

(77) Next, with reference to FIG. 8A to FIG. 8D, an example of a fundamental configuration of a laser light source according to Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure will be described.

(78) FIG. 8A is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of a laser light source **200** according to Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure. FIG. 8B is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **200** in FIG. 8A. FIG. 8C is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. 8B taken along line VIIC-VIIC, which is parallel to the YZ plane. FIG.

8D is a rear view schematically showing the laser light source **200** in FIG. 8A. The laser light source **200** according to Embodiment 2 differs from the laser light source **100** according to Embodiment 1 in the configuration of the submount **20**. The submount **20** according to Embodiment 2 includes a third submount portion **20p.sub.3** and a fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4**. The third submount portion **20p.sub.3** includes a principal surface **20s.sub.1**, a back surface **20s.sub.2**, and a front end surface **20fe**. The fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** includes: a pair of lens supports **20LS** that are fixed to the principal surface **20s.sub.1** of the third submount portion **20p.sub.3**; and a connecting portion **20L** that connects together the pair of lens supports **20LS**. The connecting portion **20L** connects the pair of lens supports **20LS** without hindering propagation of laser light emitted from the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10**. In this submount **20**, the third submount portion **20p.sub.3** and the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** are separate pieces. As in this example, the submount **20** may include a portion having the principal surface **20s.sub.1** and a portion having the pair of lens supports **20LS**, these portions being separate pieces. Although the third submount portion **20p.sub.3**, the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4**, and the collimating lens **30** are shown isolated in FIG. 8A, they are actually bonded to one another. The pair of lens supports **20LS** and the connecting portion **20L** of the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** are monolithically molded.

(79) As shown in FIG. 8B and FIG. 8C, in a top plan view, the connecting portion **20L** overlaps the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10**. As shown in FIG. 8D, the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** is disposed on the principal surface **20s.sub.1** of the third submount portion **20p.sub.3** over the laser diode chip **10**. With the size of the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** along the X direction being larger than the size of the third submount portion **20p.sub.3** along the X direction, the area of the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS** can be increased. This allows for facilitating bonding of the collimating lens **30** onto the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS**. The size of the pair of lens supports **20LS** of the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** along the Y direction may be approximately the same as the size of the collimating lens **30** along the Y direction. The size of the pair of lens supports **20LS** of the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** along the Y direction may be greater than, equal to, or smaller than the size of the collimating lens **30** along the Y direction. The fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** may have a size along the X direction of e.g. 0.5 mm or greater and 4 mm or less, the largest size along the Y direction of e.g. 0.5 mm or greater and 2 mm or less, and a size along the Z direction of e.g. 0.5 mm or greater and 1 mm or less.

(80) In the production of the laser light source **200** according to Embodiment 2, a step of bonding the laser diode chip **10** to the principal surface **20s.sub.1** of the third submount portion **20p.sub.3**, a step of bonding the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** to the principal surface **20s.sub.1** of the third submount portion **20p.sub.3** over the laser diode chip **10**, and a step of bonding the collimating lens **30** to the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS** of the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** may be performed in this order. Alternatively, the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** with the collimating lens **30** bonded thereto may be bonded onto the third submount portion **20p.sub.3** with the laser diode chip **10** bonded to its principal surface **20s.sub.1**.

(81) In the laser light source **200** according to Embodiment 2, as in the laser light source **100** according to Embodiment 1, the submount **20** supports the laser diode chip **10** on the principal surface **20s.sub.1** between the pair of lens supports **20LS**, and supports the collimating lens **30** on the end surfaces **20se** of the pair of lens supports **20LS**. This allows for facilitating alignment between the laser diode chip **10** and the collimating lens **30**, and allows for obtaining the laser light source **200** of a small size. Furthermore, in the laser light source **200** according to Embodiment 2, as in the laser light source **100** according to Embodiment 1, even when the laser diode chip **10** is disposed on the submount **20** in a face-down state, climbing-up of the bonding material onto the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** can be reduced.

Modified Examples of Embodiment 2

(82) Next, Modified Example 1 and Modified Example 2 of the laser light source **200** according to Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure will be described. Descriptions repetitive of the description above may be omitted.

(83) With reference to FIG. **9A** to FIG. **9D**, an example of a configuration of a laser light source **210** according to Modified Example 1 of Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure will be described. FIG. **9A** is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of the laser light source **210** according to Modified Example 1 of Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure. FIG. **9B** is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **210** in FIG. **9A**. FIG. **9C** is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. **9B** taken along line IXC-IXC, which is parallel to the YZ plane. FIG. **9D** is a rear view schematically showing the laser light source **210** in FIG. **9A**. The laser light source **210** according to Modified Example 1 of Embodiment 2 differs from the laser light source **200** according to Embodiment 2 in the shape of the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** of the submount **20**. The fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** according to Modified Example 1 of Embodiment 2 defines a recess **20co** between the pair of lens supports **20LS**, in the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** according to Embodiment 2. As shown in FIG. **9B** and FIG. **9C**, with the recess **20co**, the connecting portion **20L** does not overlap the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** in a top plan view. The recess **20co** has a size along the X direction of e.g. 0.2 mm or greater and 3 mm or less, and a size along the Z direction of e.g. 0.5 mm or greater and 1 mm or less. The size of the recess **20co** along the Z direction is larger than the distance between the end surface **20se** of each of the pair of lens supports **20LS** and the edge **20ed** of the principal surface **20s.sub.1** of the third submount portion **20p.sub.3** along the Z direction. In the production of the laser light source **210** according to Modified Example 1 of Embodiment 2, the recess **20co** allows for facilitating alignment between the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** and the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** and alignment between the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** and the collimating lens **30**.

(84) Next, with reference to FIG. **10A** to FIG. **10D**, an example of a configuration of a laser light source **220** according to Modified Example 2 of Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure will be described. FIG. **10A** is a perspective view schematically showing an example of a configuration of the laser light source **220** according to Modified Example 2 of Embodiment 2 of the present disclosure. FIG. **10B** is a top plan view schematically showing the laser light source **220** in FIG. **10A**. FIG. **10C** is a cross-sectional view of the configuration of FIG. **10B** taken along line XC-XC, which is parallel to the YZ plane. FIG. **10D** is a perspective view schematically showing the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** and the collimating lens **30** shown in FIG. **10A**. The laser light source **220** according to Modified Example 2 of Embodiment 2 differs from the laser light source **200** according to Embodiment 2 in the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** of the submount **20** and the collimating lens **30**. As shown in FIG. **10D**, according to Modified Example 2 of Embodiment 2, the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** of the submount **20** and the collimating lens **30** are monolithically molded. The fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** and the collimating lens **30** do not need to be bonded to each other, so that the size of the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** according to Modified Example 2 of Embodiment 2 along the X direction does not need to be as large as the size of the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** according to Embodiment 2 along the X direction. The fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** according to Modified Example 2 of Embodiment 2 has a size along the X direction of e.g. 0.2 mm or greater and 3 mm or less, the largest size along the Y direction of e.g. 0.3 mm or greater and 1 mm or less, and a size along the Z direction of e.g. 0.5 mm or greater and 1 mm or less.

(85) The fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** and the collimating lens **30** that are monolithically molded may be made of, for example, at least one of glass, quartz, synthetic quartz, sapphire, transparent ceramics, and plastics. When the fourth submount portion **20p.sub.4** and the collimating lens **30** that are monolithically molded are transparent, alignment between the emission end surface **10e.sub.1** of the laser diode chip **10** and the collimating lens **30** can be facilitated.

(86) Components in the embodiments described above and components in Modified Examples thereof may be combined in any appropriate manners.

APPLICATION EXAMPLES

(87) A laser light source according to the present disclosure can be used for light sources for a direct diode laser that combines a plurality of laser beams for an enhanced output power, for example. Combining of beams are to be performed by accurately combining laser beams that are emitted from a plurality of laser light sources. With a high-intensity laser beam having a wavelength of 570 nm or less, even a metal such as copper can be easily processed. In a laser light source according to the present disclosure, a misalignment between a laser diode chip and a lens is unlikely to occur; therefore, the optical axis of the laser light that is emitted to the outside from the laser light source will not be greatly misoriented. This allows for accurately combining laser beams that are emitted from a plurality of such laser light sources, which allows for increasing beam quality.

INDUSTRIAL APPLICABILITY

(88) A laser light source according to the present disclosure can also be used for, for example, projectors and illumination devices.

REFERENCE SIGNS LIST

(89) **10** laser diode chip **10a** semiconductor multilayer structure **10b** substrate **10C.sub.1** first cladding layer **10C.sub.2** second cladding layer **10e.sub.1** emission end surface **10e.sub.2** rear end surface **10L** emission layer **20** submount **20co** recess **20d** groove **20ed** edge **20fe** front end surface **20fe.sub.1** central end surface **20fe.sub.2** side end surface **20L** connecting portion **20LS** lens support **20p.sub.1** first submount portion **20p.sub.2** second submount portion **20p.sub.3** third submount portion **20p.sub.4** fourth submount portion **20s.sub.1** principal surface **20s.sub.2** back surface **20se** end surfaces of a pair of lens supports **20us** upper surface of first submount portion **30** collimating lens **30c** lens curved-surface portion **30f** flat portion **40** semiconductor laser package **40b** base **40L** lid **40w** light-transmitting window **50** lead terminal **60** collet **60a** fork portion **60b** support portion **100, 110, 120, 130, 140, 150** laser light source **200, 210, 220** laser light source

Claims

1. A laser light source comprising: an edge-emitting type laser diode chip that comprises: a semiconductor multilayer structure comprising an emission layer, and a substrate supporting the semiconductor multilayer structure, wherein: the laser diode chip has a first end surface through which laser light generated in the emission layer is emitted, and a second end surface opposite to the first end surface, and a distance from the first end surface to the second end surface defines a cavity length; a submount having a principal surface on which the laser diode chip is fixed, and a back surface located opposite to the principal surface, the submount comprising a pair of lens supports located at opposite sides with respect to the first end surface of the laser diode chip; a lens bonded to end surfaces of the pair of lens supports; and a semiconductor laser package housing the laser diode chip, the lens, and the submount; wherein: the laser diode chip is fixed to the submount such that a distance from the emission layer to the submount is less than a distance from the substrate to the submount; the first end surface of the laser diode chip is located outward in a direction along the cavity length with respect to an edge of the principal surface; the end surfaces of the pair of lens supports are located outward with respect to the first end surface of the laser diode chip in the direction along the cavity length; the submount further comprises a connecting portion connecting the pair of lens supports without hindering propagation of the laser light emitted from the first end surface of the laser diode chip, wherein the pair of lens supports and the connecting portion are monolithic; and in a top plan view, the connecting portion overlaps the first end surface of the laser diode chip.

2. The laser light source of claim 1, wherein: the semiconductor laser package comprises a base

that is in thermal contact with the back surface of the submount; and the semiconductor laser package hermetically seals the laser diode chip, the submount, and the lens.

3. The laser light source of claim 1, wherein: the submount has a front end surface connecting the principal surface and the back surface; the front end surface has a central end surface and side end surfaces that are located on opposite sides of the central end surface; the central end surface is recessed with respect to the side end surfaces in the direction along the cavity length; and the edge of the principal surface is defined by the principal surface and the central end surface of the submount.

4. The laser light source of claim 1, wherein the submount includes a groove extending in the direction along the cavity length between each of the pair of lens supports and the laser diode chip.

5. The laser light source of claim 1, wherein the lens is bonded to the end surfaces of the pair of lens supports via an inorganic material.

6. The laser light source of claim 1, wherein a portion or an entirety of the submount is made of a ceramic.

7. The laser light source of claim 6, wherein the submount includes a through-hole extending from the principal surface and reaching the back surface, and a metal filling the through-hole.

8. The laser light source of claim 1, wherein, when viewed in the direction along the cavity length, a centroid of the lens is located between the pair of lens supports.

9. The laser light source of claim 1, wherein the laser light has a wavelength of 350 nm or more and 570 nm or less.

10. The laser light source claim 1, wherein: the lens has a structure elongated along a direction that is perpendicular to a normal direction of the principal surface and to the direction along the cavity length; and the lens reduces a divergence angle of the laser light within a plane extending in the normal direction of the principal surface and in the direction along the cavity length.

11. The laser light source of claim 1, wherein the lens includes a pair of flat portions and a lens curved-surface portion located between the pair of flat portions.

12. The laser light source of claim 1, wherein the pair of lens supports, the connecting portion, and the lens are monolithic.

13. The laser light source of claim 1, wherein: the submount comprises a submount portion comprising the principal surface, and another submount portion comprising the pair of lens supports; and the submount portion and the other submount portion are separate pieces.

14. The laser light source of claim 1, wherein the lens and the end surfaces of the pair of lens supports are bonded via a bonding material.
